

# OBSERVUM THE TIRELESS NETWORK MONITOR



Network monitoring involves constant monitoring of how the network functions by collecting useful data from its various parts, which helps to alert the network administrator in case of failures. Observium is an open source network monitoring platform that supports a range of operating systems. Let's take a look at how to install it on CentOS, its features and how it compares with other such platforms.

Observium is a network monitoring platform that supports a wide range of operating systems such as Windows, Cisco, Juniper, Dell, HP and Linux. It is open source and free, and based on PHP/MySQL. It collects data from devices by using the Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP) and displays it through graphical presentation via a Web interface. It makes use of the RRDtool package, and requires no manual interpretation or very little of it. It can be integrated with some other open source tools for network monitoring such as Cacti or Nagios. Observium uses the GeSHi and jgraph software packages to extend its features.

The platform supports IPv6 address tracking, VLAN tracking, VRF and pseudowire tracking, device inventory tracking, session tracking and so on. It also supports auto discovery of the network infrastructure, and finds the network section that needs to be monitored.

## Installation of Observium on CentOS

The following steps will help you install Observium on the CentOS, x86\_64 platform.

1. Install the RPM Forge and EPEL repositories as follows:

```
rpm --import http://apt.sw.be/RPM-GPG-KEY.dag.txt
rpm -Uvh http://packages.sw.be/rpmforge-release/rpmforge-release-0.5.2-2.el6.rf.x86_64.rpm
rpm -Uvh http://download.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/6/i386/epel-release-6-8.noarch.rpm
```

2. Install the required packages for Observium as follows:

```
yum install wget.x86_64 httpd.x86_64 php.x86_64 php-mysql.x86_64 php-gd.x86_64 php-posix.x86_64 php-mcrypt.x86_64 php-pear.noarch \
vixie-cron.x86_64 net-snmp.x86_64 net-snmp-utils.x86_64 \
fping.x86_64 mysql-server.x86_64 mysql.x86_64 MySQL-python.x86_64 \
rrdtool.x86_64 subversion.x86_64 jwhois.x86_64 ipmitool.x86_64 graphviz.x86_64 ImageMagick.x86_64
```

3. Download the latest .tar.gz of Observium and uncompress it as follows:

```
wget http://www.observium.org/observium-community-latest.tar.gz
```